All communities have a government. A government is a group of people that makes laws to lead the citizens. Its job is to keep everyone safe, protect property, control disputes or conflict and to keep all of the government services running properly.

Introduction

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

A disagreement or argument is a dispute or conflict.

Court is a place where a judge and jury decide if laws were broken and what punishment to enforce.

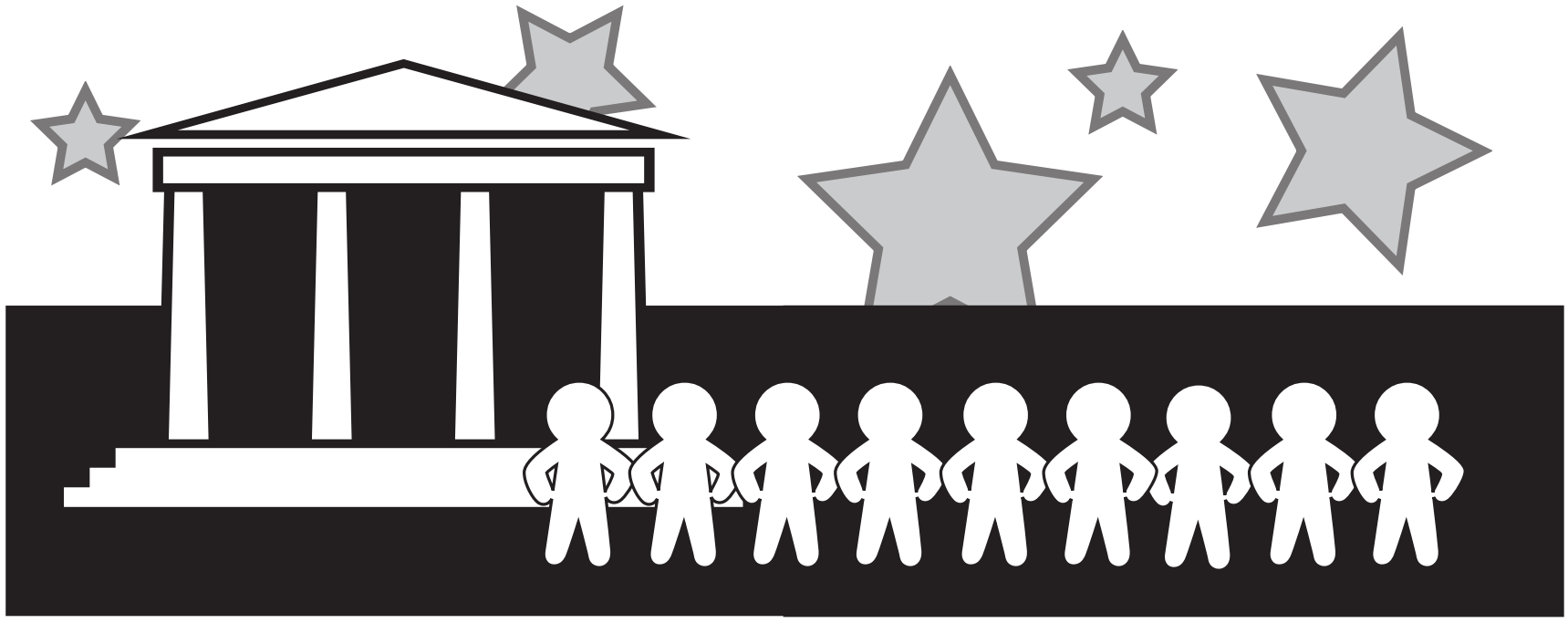
A small group of 6–12 citizens that listens to a dispute or conflict in a courtroom is a jury.

Property that belongs to all citizens, like parks and roads, is called public property.

Property that belongs to one person or a group of people, like a house or business, is called private property.

Introduction

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.



a. court
b. public property
c. jury
d. government
e. safe
f. private property
g. conflict

_____ land that belongs to all citizens

_____ a judge decides if laws were broken

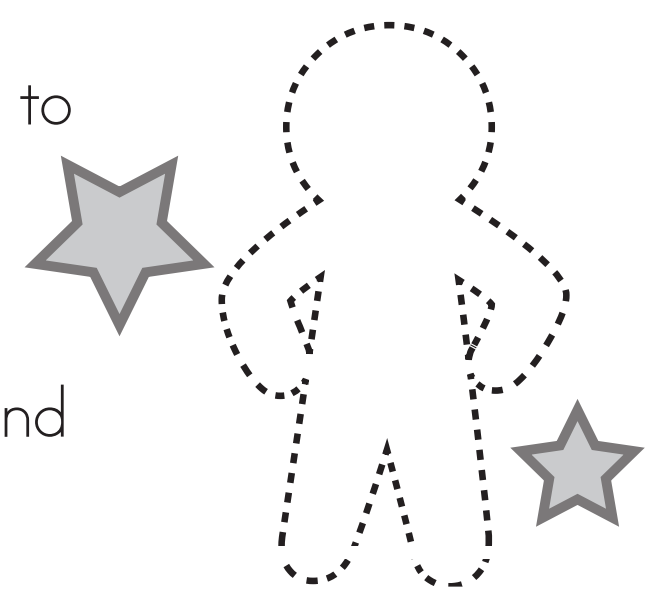
_____ a group of people that makes laws

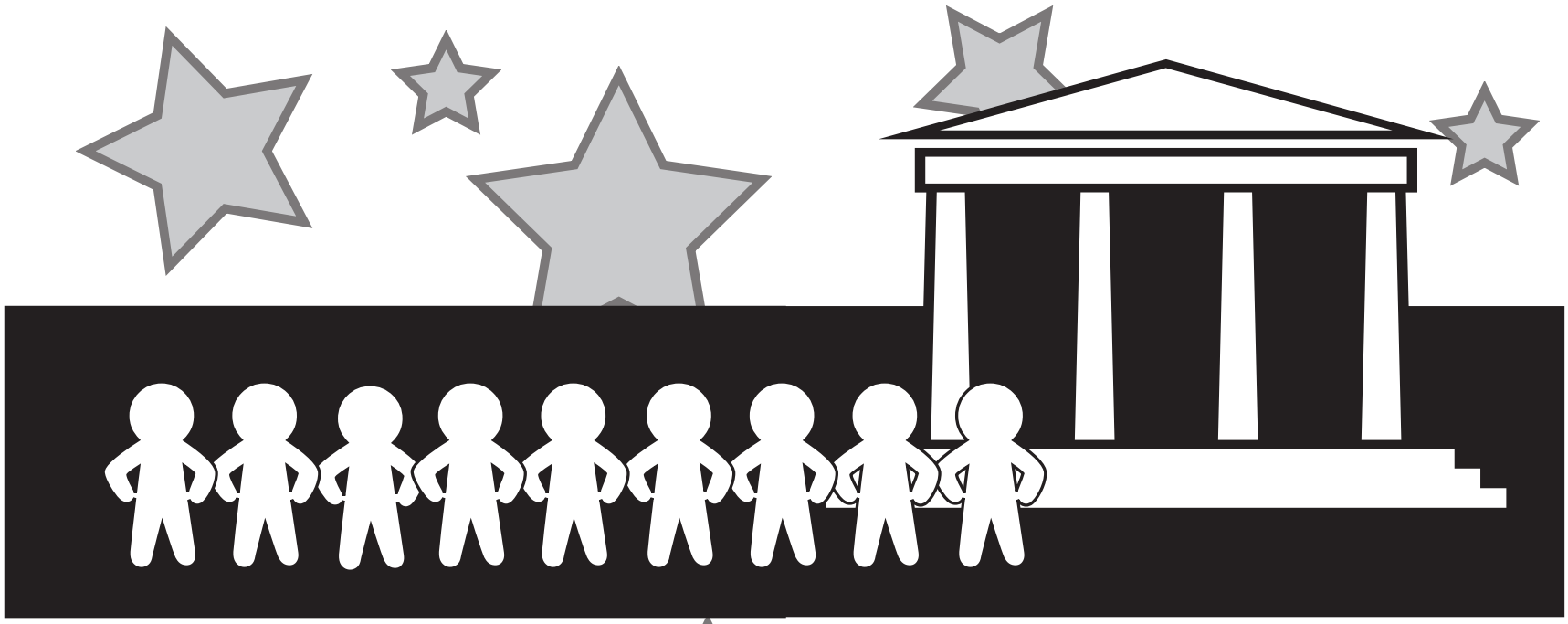
_____ a disagreement or argument

_____ property that belongs to one citizen

_____ a small group of citizens that listens to a conflict in a courtroom

_____ the government's job is to keep us _____, protect property and control conflict





a. court
b. public property
c. jury
d. government
e. safe
f. private property
g. conflict

_____ land that belongs to all citizens
b

_____ a judge decides if laws were broken
a

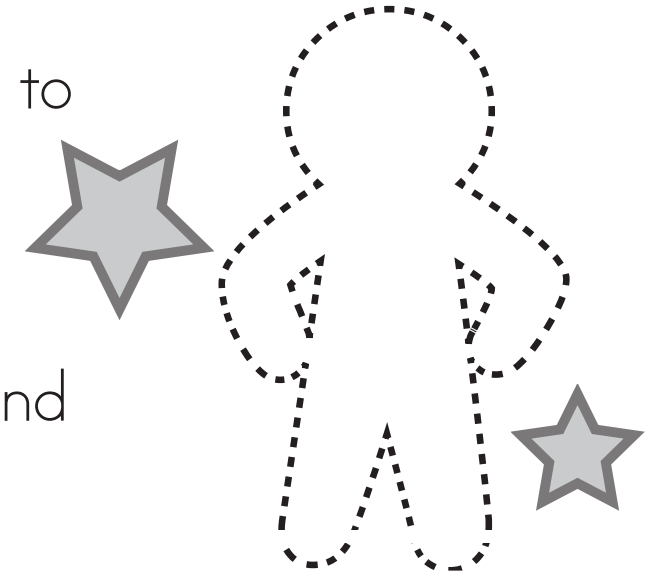
_____ a group of people that makes laws
d

_____ a disagreement or argument
g

_____ property that belongs to one citizen
f

_____ a small group of citizens that listens to a conflict in a courtroom
c

_____ the government's job is to keep us _____, protect property and control conflict
e



Governments help keep us safe.

Introduction

Circle all the things that are wrong in this picture.

Another job of our government is to provide services. Government service is work that is done for citizens.

Our government keeps us safe with police officers and fire fighters. Some communities have health departments, clinics or hospitals to keep everyone healthy. The government builds schools for the the community to provide public education.

Many communities have parks, baseball or soccer fields, swimming pools or golf courses for citizens to enjoy. These activities or hobbies are called recreation.

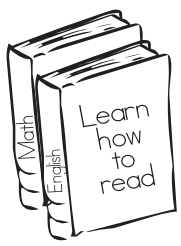
The government takes care of needs like garbage pick-up, street repair and clean water, services that are called public works and are paid for by taxes. A tax is money citizens pay when they own property or when they buy something. Without taxes our government would not be able to provide these very important services.

Services

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

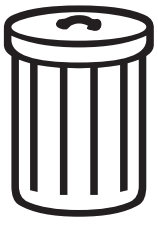
Government service is work that is done for citizens.

Safety and health are important services that are met through police officers, fire fighters and medical clinics.



Our government builds schools for public education.

Soccer fields and swimming pools are provided for recreation.



Important needs like garbage pick-up and clean water are called public works.

These services are paid for by taxes. A tax is money citizens pay when they own property or when they buy something. Without taxes our government would not be able to provide these very important services.

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

____ Taxes are very important.

____ Our government does not provide education.

____ Garbage pick-up and clean water are not part of the government.

____ The police and fire department keep us safe.

____ Our health is not important to the government.

____ You pay taxes for government services when you buy things.

____ Our government doesn't like baseball fields.

Services

Write (T) True or (F) False in the blanks.

_____ Taxes are very important.
T

_____ Our government does not provide education.
F

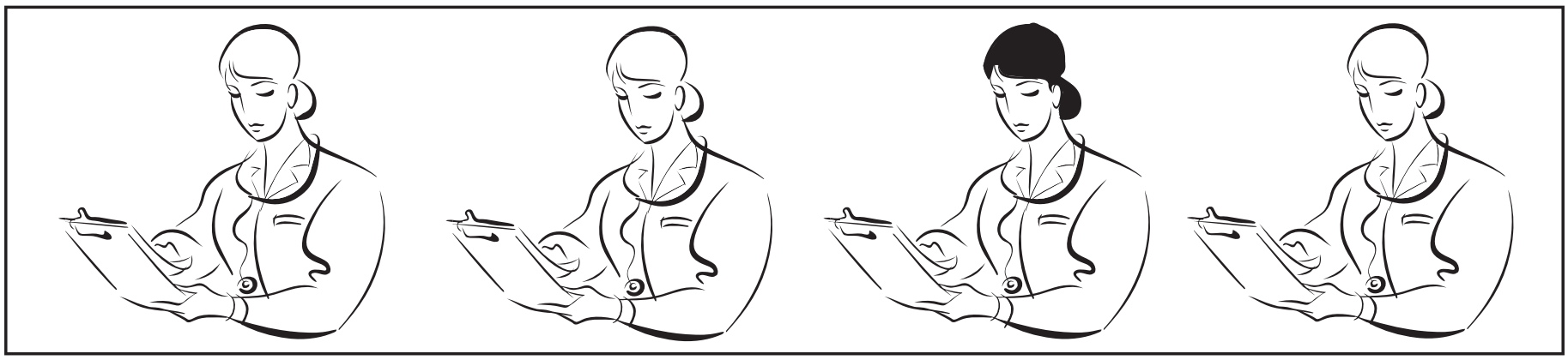
_____ Garbage pick-up and clean water are not part of the government.
F

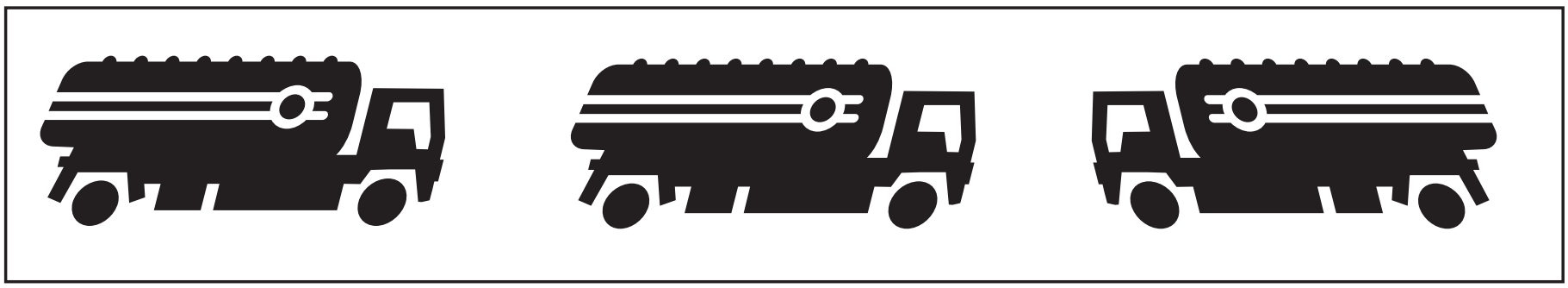
_____ The police and fire department keep us safe.
T

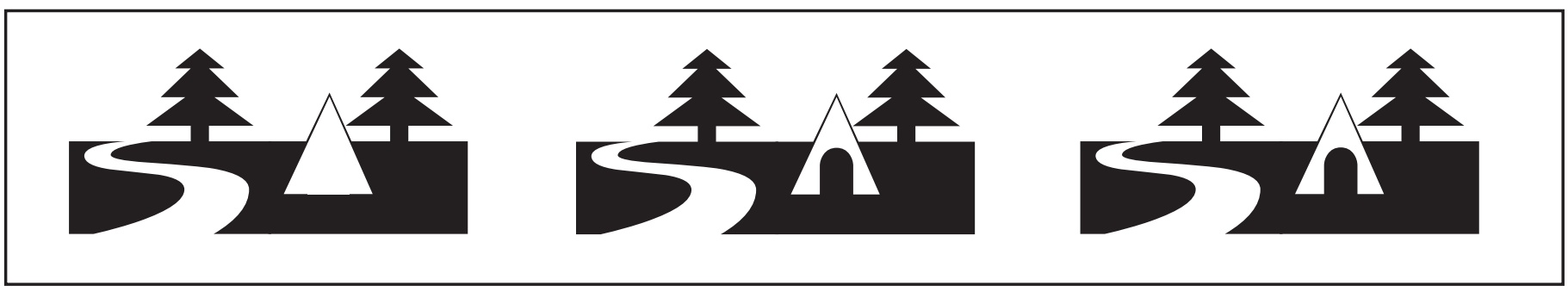
_____ Our health is not important to the government.
F

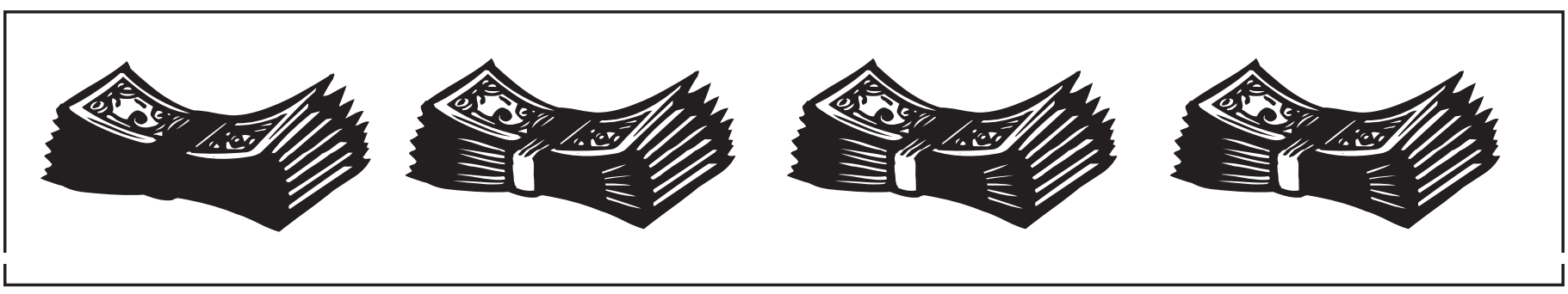
_____ You pay taxes for government services when you buy things.
T

_____ Our government doesn't like baseball fields.
F









Services

Circle the picture that is different.

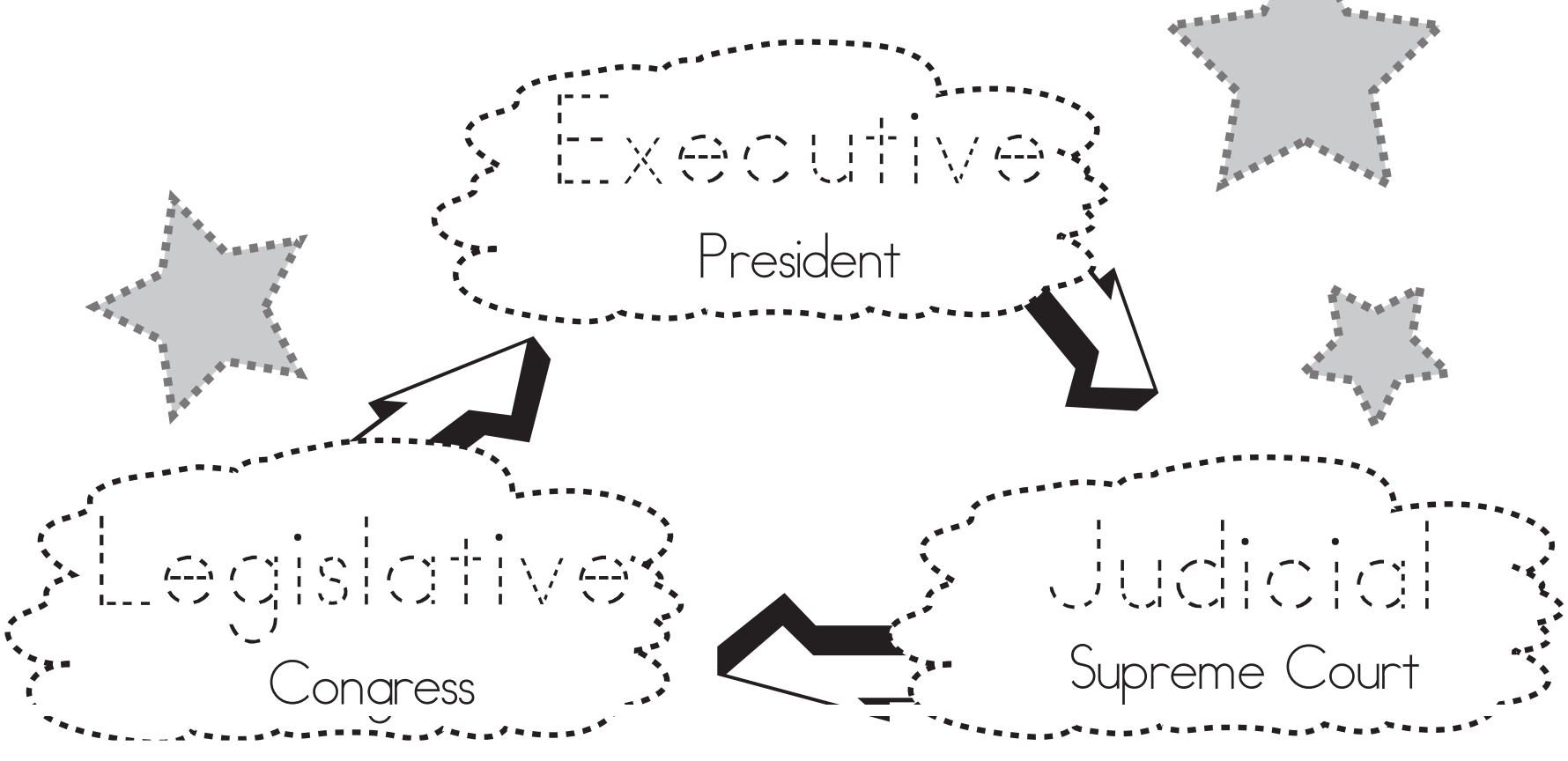
In our government there are three different groups called branches. These branches have different jobs, but they are all connected like branches on a tree. Our government has three branches: executive, legislative and judicial.

The executive branch oversees the laws and makes sure citizens obey them.

The legislative branch is a group of people that writes the new laws.

The judicial branch makes sure the laws are fair and that the punishment is fair.

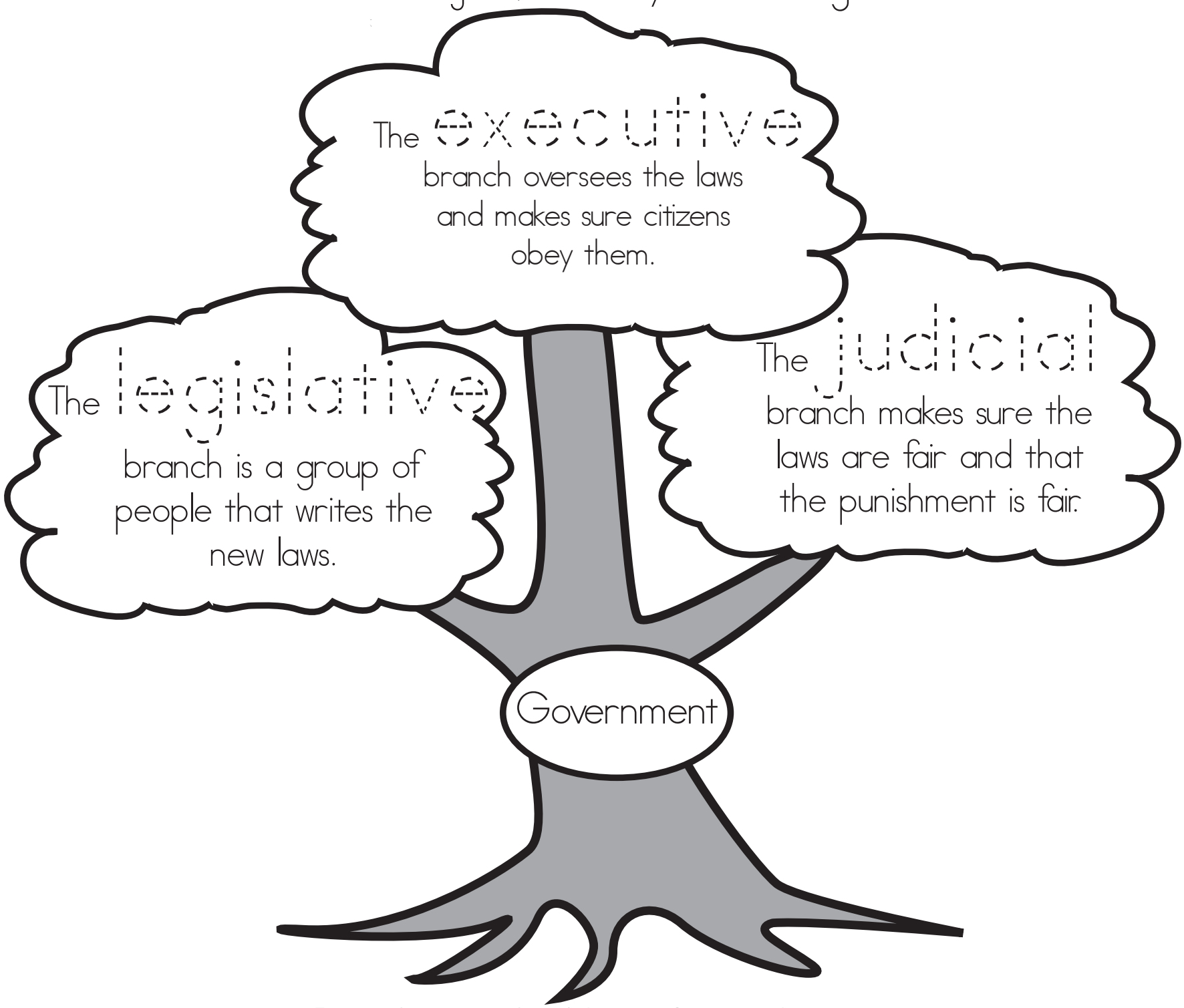
Branches of the Unites States Government



Branches

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

In our government there are three different groups called branches. These branches have different jobs, but they all work together.



Branches of the Unites States Government

Executive – President

Legislative – Congress

Judicial – Supreme Court

Branches

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

President •

Makes sure laws are fair •

A group that writes new laws •

Congress •

Makes sure punishment is fair •

Supreme Court •

• Executive

• Legislative

• Judicial

Word Bank:

three together different

All of the branches have _____

jobs, but they work _____ .

There are _____ branches of government.

Branches

Match the setences to the branch of Government and fill in the blanks.

President

Makes sure laws are fair

A group that writes new laws

Congress

Makes sure punishment is fair

Supreme Court

Executive

Legislative

Judicial

Word Bank:

three **together** **different**

All of the branches have _____
different

jobs, but they work _____ .
together

There are _____ branches of government.
three

Branches

Help the squirrel get the hole in the trunk.

There are also different levels of government.

There are two types of local government. The first one is the government in your city or town. The second local government is your county.

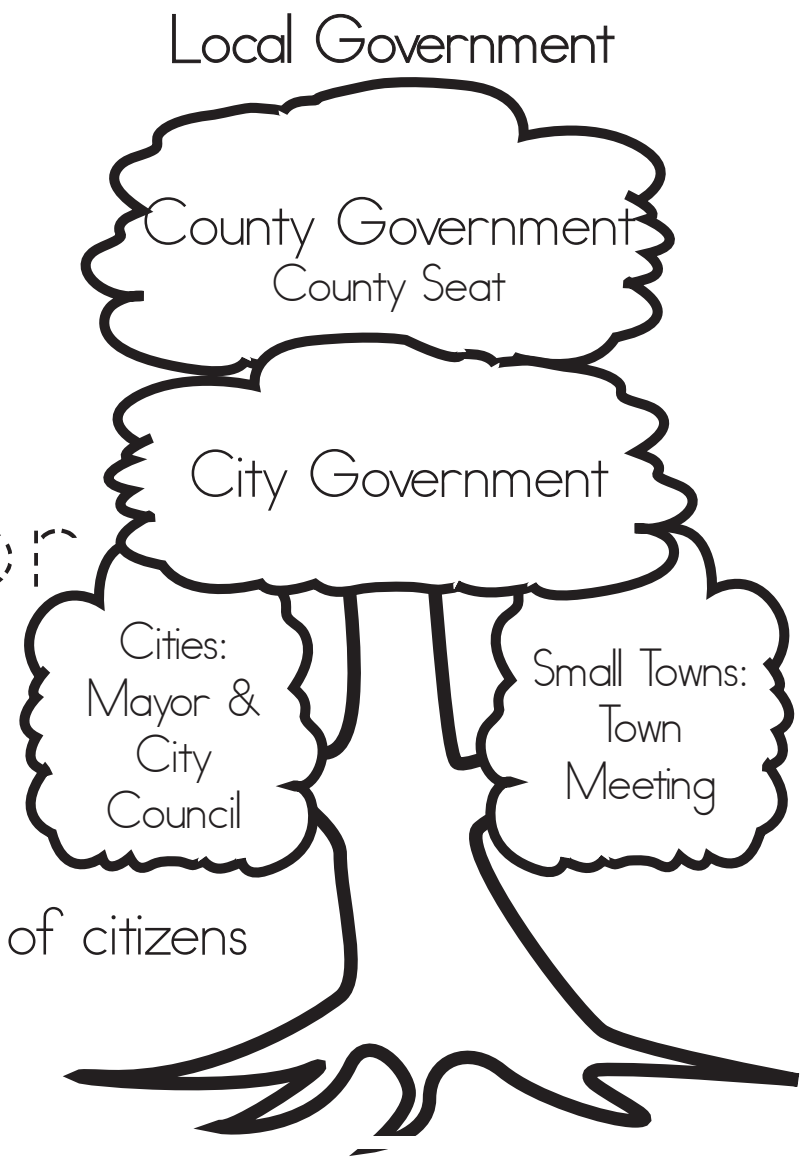
A county is a group of cities that is part of a state.

The county seat is where the county government officials meet and where the government buildings are located.

Small towns have town meetings in which all citizens meet to make rules and laws.

Some cities and towns have a mayor who oversees the laws and government decisions.

A city council is a group of citizens that makes rules and laws for its city.



Local Government:

There are two types of local government.
The first one is the government in your city or town.
The second local government is your county.

County Government:

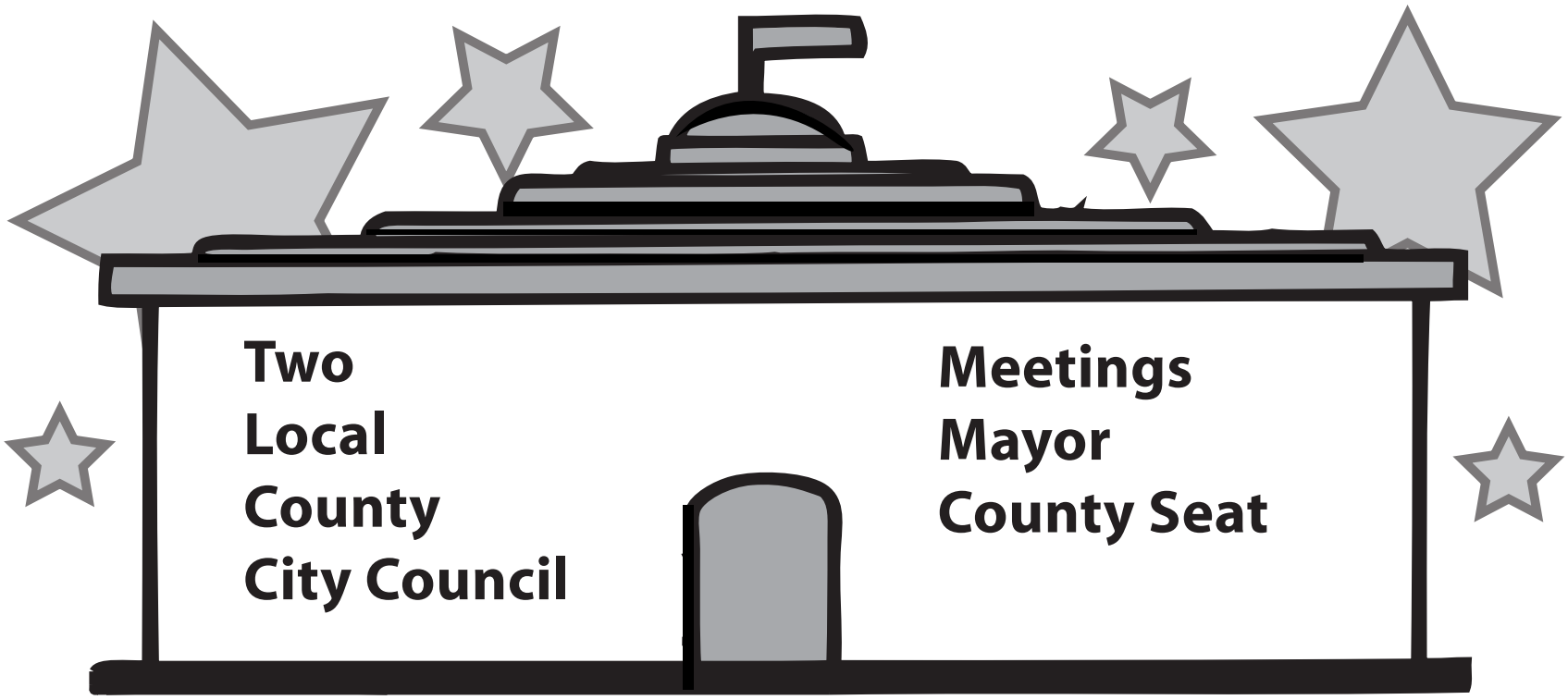
A county is a group of cities that is part of a state.
The county seat is where the county government officials meet and where the government buildings are located.

City Government:

Small towns have town meetings in which all citizens meet to make rules and laws.

Some cities and towns have a mayor who oversees the laws and government decisions.
A city council is a group of citizens

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.



A _____ is a group of cities that is part of a state.

Some towns and cities have a _____ who oversees the laws and government decisions.

The _____ is where the coun officials meet and where the government buildings are located.

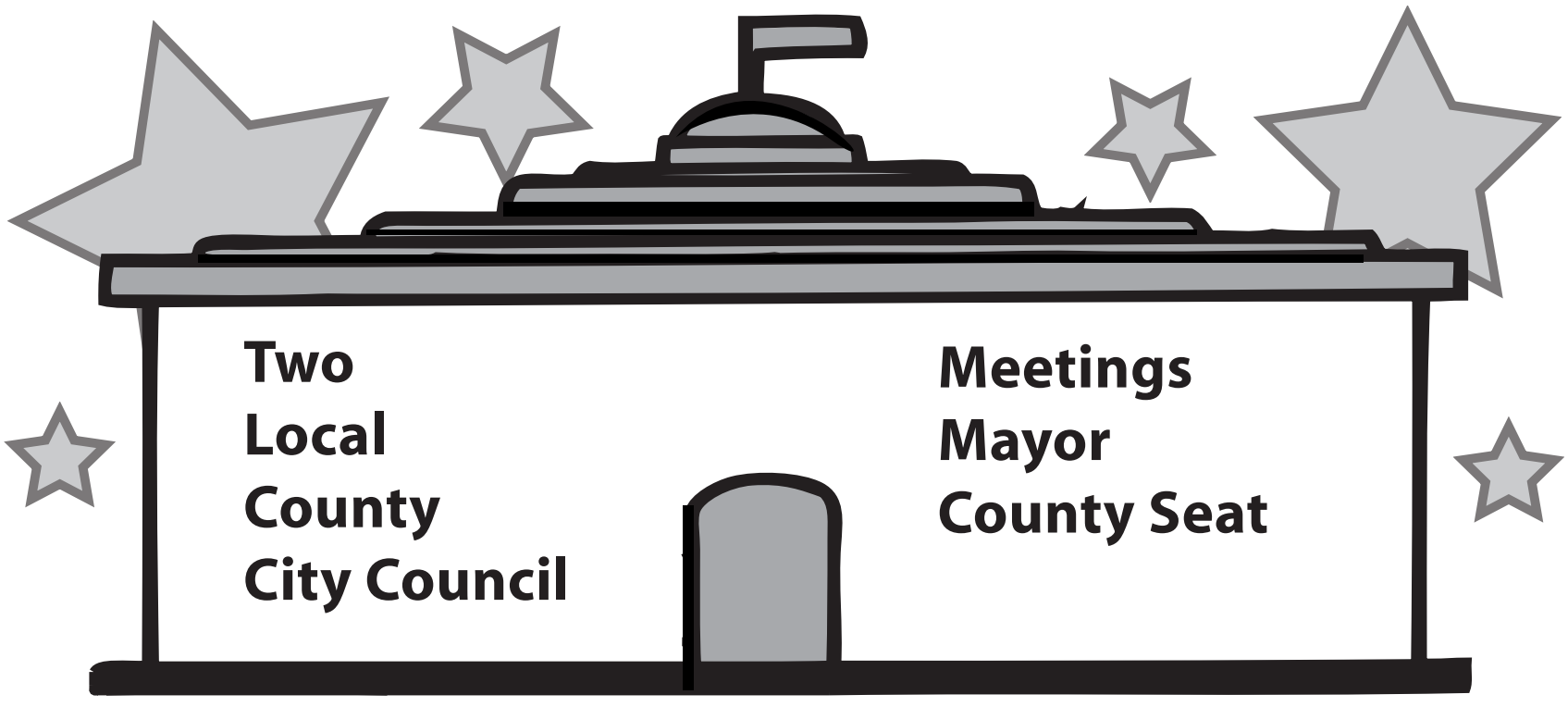
There are _____ types of _____ government

A _____ is a group of citizens tha makes rules and laws for its city.

Some small towns have town _____

Local

Fill in the blanks.



A _____ is a group of cities that is
county
part of a state.

Some towns and cities have a _____ who
mayor
oversees the laws and government decisions.

The _____ is where the coun
county seat
officials meet and where the government buildings are located.

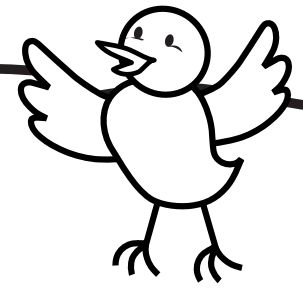
There are _____ types of _____ government
two **local**

A _____ is a group of citizens tha
City Council
makes rules and laws for its city.

Some small towns have town _____
meetings

Local *Answers*

**** Words can be found going up, down, sideways or diagonally.***



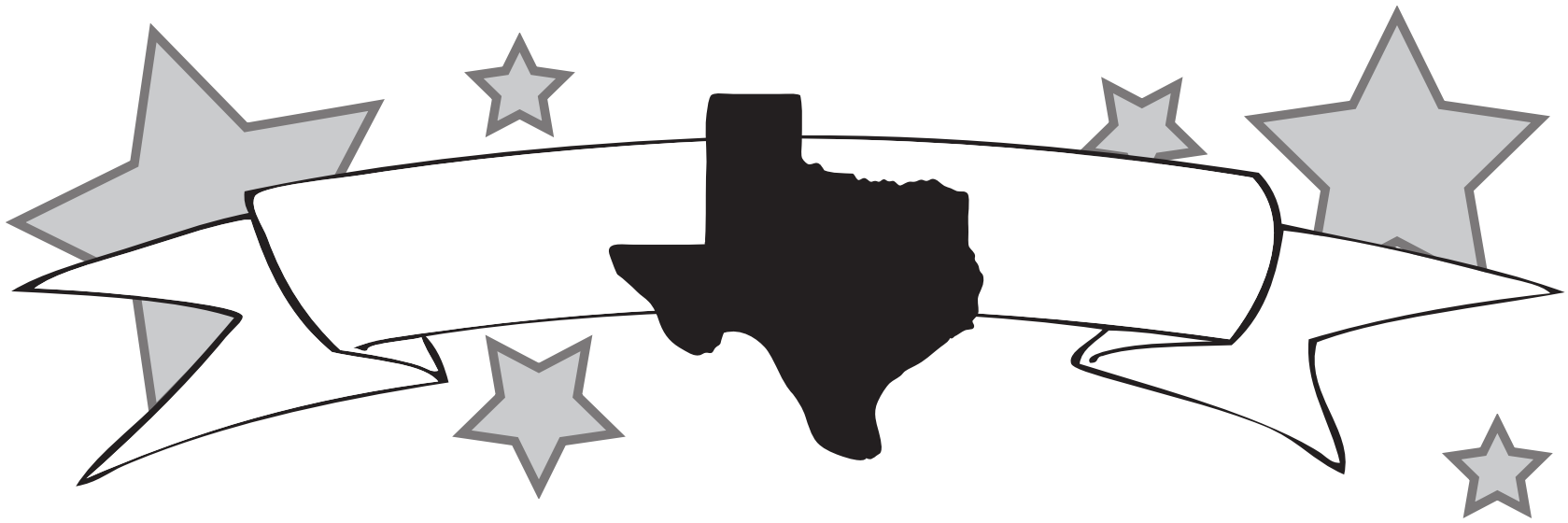
Court	**Government**	**Taxes**	**Legislative**
Jury	**Local**	**Recreation**	**Executive**
Services	**City**	**Safety**	**Judicial**
Garbage	**County**	**Health**	**President**
Water	**Laws**	**Education**	**Mayor**

** Bonus Words: City Council & Town meeting*

P	O	L	A	W	S	R	E	C	R	E	A	T	I	O	N
R	B	F	H	V	K	C	D	P	N	Y	P	B	R	D	T
E	G	C	U	J	W	L	U	E	Q	S	A	F	E	T	Y
S	E	P	L	O	V	E	C	R	F	E	H	O	J	P	R
I	L	S	D	T	O	Y	A	V	J	R	D	E	T	H	L
D	Q	N	H	E	A	L	T	H	B	V	W	I	X	K	E
E	Z	O	D	T	G	U	I	C	J	I	L	W	N	E	G
N	Q	C	S	F	R	H	O	E	Y	C	P	M	Z	X	I
T	A	L	U	C	K	R	N	S	P	E	U	R	S	E	S
J	U	D	I	C	I	A	L	G	T	S	W	L	V	C	L
V	B	M	W	D	L	S	X	H	X	G	I	O	Y	U	A
G	C	N	X	E	M	T	Y	I	N	C	A	C	Z	T	T
O	D	T	A	X	E	S	Z	I	N	E	F	A	G	I	I
V	E	O	Y	F	N	U	T	U	B	H	O	L	P	V	V
E	F	P	Z	G	O	E	O	J	W	I	Q	V	W	E	E
R	G	Q	A	N	E	C	A	G	A	R	B	A	G	E	D
N	H	R	B	M	Y	O	B	K	T	J	R	X	B	C	E
M	I	S	N	T	P	U	C	L	E	K	S	Y	J	L	F
E	J	W	I	J	Q	N	D	M	R	L	T	Z	U	K	H
N	O	C	O	U	R	T	E	N	C	M	U	A	R	J	I
T	K	T	C	I	T	Y	F	O	D	N	M	A	Y	O	R

Local

Find and circle the words from the Word Bank.



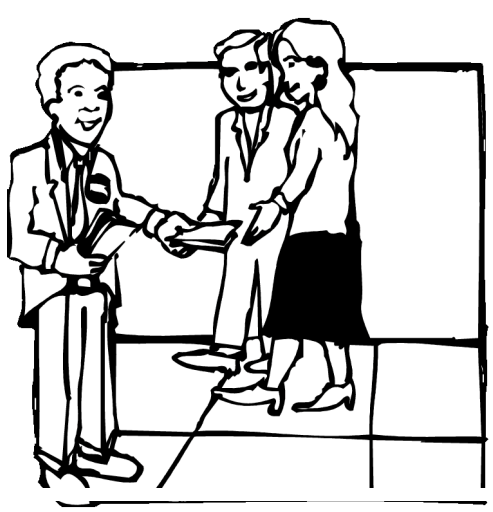
Each state has its own state government.

Voters elect the officials in the state government.

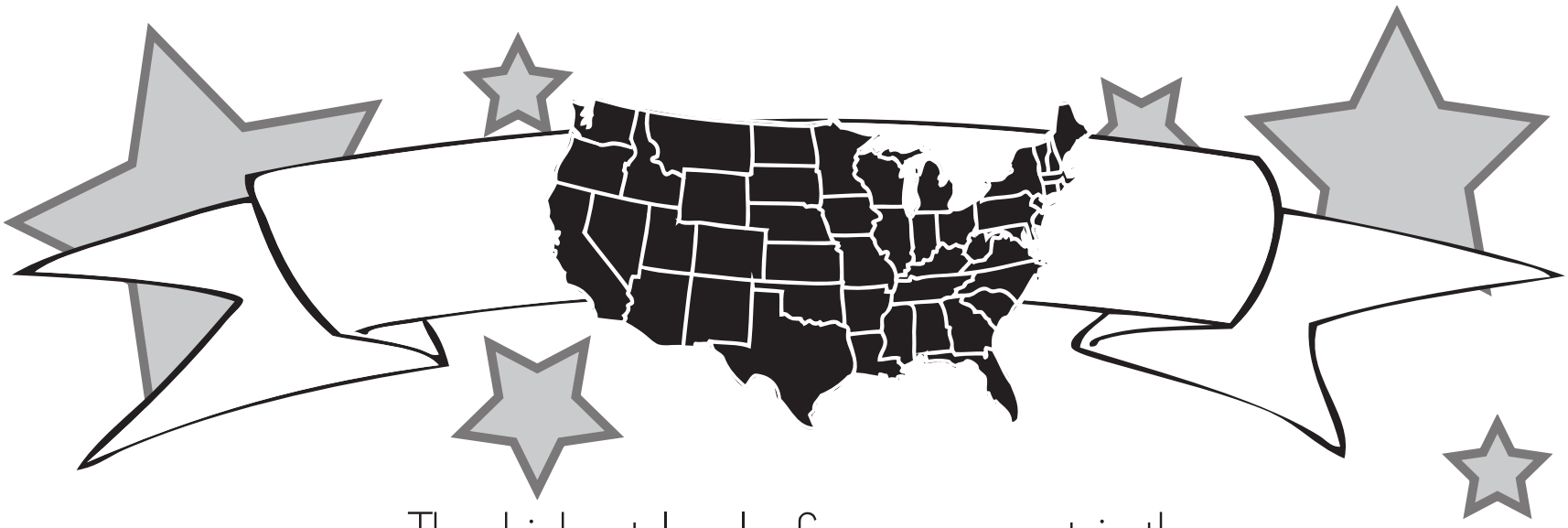
The state capitol is where the government officials meet and where the state government buildings are located.

The governor is the leader of the state government.

The state government has three branches:
executive, legislative and judicial.



Read the information and trace all the dotted words.



The highest level of government is the
national government.

Voters elect the officials in the national government.

The national government has three branches:
legislative and judicial.

The Capitol is where the government officials meet
in Washington D.C..

The President is the leader of the national government.

The Supreme Court is the most important court
in the U.S.; there are nine judges on the court.

The Constitution is a set of laws the

1. _____ elect the officials in the state and national government.

mayors voters branches

2. The _____ is where the government officials meet and where the government buildings are located.

mountains city hall Capitol

3. The _____ is the leader of the state government.

governor mayor city council

4. The _____ is a set of laws the U.S. government obeys.

Capitol Supreme Court Constitution

5. The _____ is the leader of the national government.

governor mayor President

6. The _____ is the most important court in the U.S. and there are nine judges in the court.

Supreme Court highest court important court

State and National

Circle the correct answer.

1. _____ elect the officials in the state and national government.

mayors voters branches

2. The _____ is where the government officials meet and where the government buildings are located.

mountains city hall Capitol

3. The _____ is the leader of the state government.

governor mayor city council

4. The _____ is a set of laws the U.S. government obeys.

Capitol Supreme Court Constitution

5. The _____ is the leader of the national government.

governor mayor President

6. The _____ is the most important court in the U.S. and there are nine judges in the court.

Supreme Court highest court important court

What new law would you like to see? _____

Draw a picture of yourself as the President.

All citizens have rights and responsibilities.

Rights are the freedoms that all U.S. citizens have.

Some of the rights listed in the Bill of Rights:

Freedom of speech

Freedom of the press

Freedom of assembly

Right to a speedy and public trial

Right against cruel and unusual punishment.

Right to keep and bear arms

Right to a jury

It is your responsibility to be a good citizen.

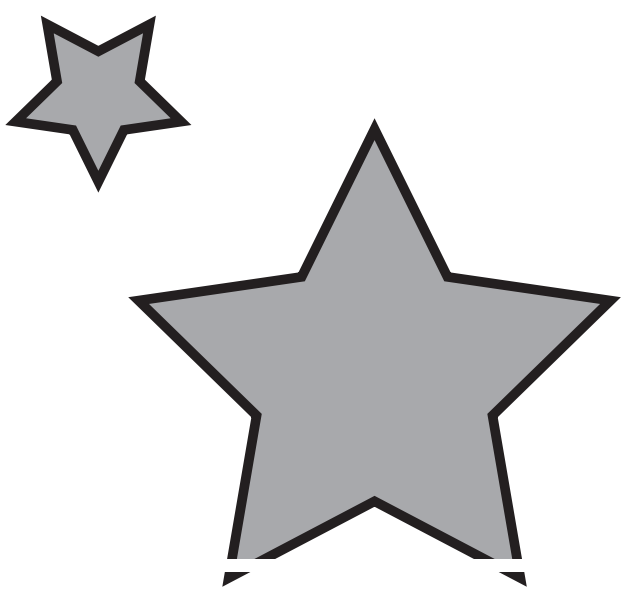
The Bill of Rights is the first 10 amendments to the Constitution.

Another right we have is religion, which is a belief in God or gods.

Citizens have a responsibility to vote so the government will make good choices and helpful laws.

An election is a special time when citizens vote for government officials.

A ballot is what voters use to mark their choices during an election.



Rights and Responsibilities

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

All citizens have rights, freedoms and responsibilities.

rights — Freedoms that all U.S. citizens have.

Bill of Rights — The first 10 rights listed in the Constitution.

religion — Another right is the freedom to religion; a belief in God or gods.

vote — Citizens have a responsibility to vote so the government will make good choices and helpful laws.

election — A special time when citizens vote for government officials.

ballot — What voters use to mark their choices during an election.

Read the information and trace all the dotted words.

The _____ ***liBl*** of _____ ***shRgti*** is the first 10 rights listed in the Constitution.

A _____ ***lbotla*** is what voters use to mark their choice during an election

Another right we have is _____ ***nielgiro*** , which is a belief in God or gods.

Citizens have a responsibility to _____ ***etov*** so the government will make good choices and helpful laws.

_____ ***tgisRh*** are the freedoms that all U.S. citizens have.

An _____ ***netcielo*** is a special time when citizens vote for government officials.

Rights and Responsibilities

Fill in the blanks with the scrambled words.

The _____ ***liBl*** of _____ ***shRgti*** is the first
Bill **Rights**
10 rights listed in the Constitution.

A _____ ***lbotla*** is what voters use to mark their
ballot
choice during an election

Another right we have is _____ ***nielgiro*** ,
religion
which is a belief in God or gods.

Citizens have a responsibility to _____ ***etov*** so the
vote
government will make good choices and helpful laws.

_____ ***tgisRh*** are the freedoms that all U.S. citizens
Rights
have.

An _____ ***netcielo*** is a special time when
election
citizens vote for government officials.

President of your school:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Governor of the cafeteria:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Mayor of your grade:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Judge of the playground:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

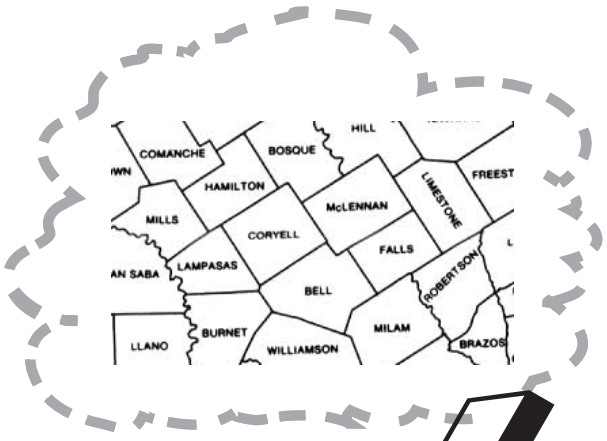
Put a check by the names of the people you would choose in an election.

You have just created a ballot!

Fill in the blanks with people you know for each category.

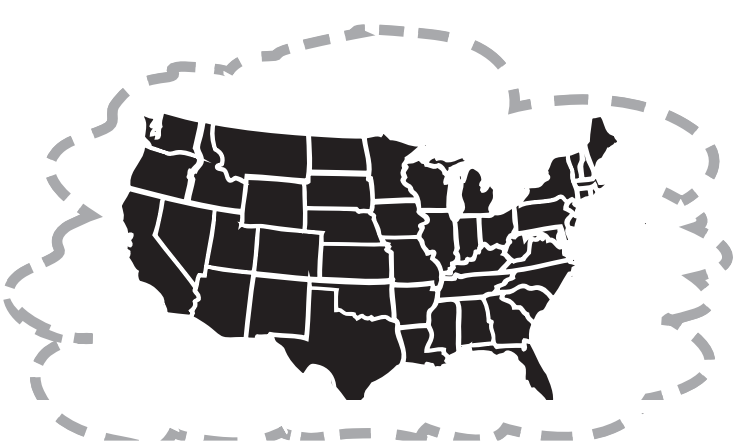
★ Local Government:

1. Town or City
   - Mayor
   - City Council
   - Town Meetings



2. County
   - County Seat

★ State Government:
- Governor
- State Capitol
- Three Branches: Executive, Legislative and Judicial



★ National Government:
- Executive: President
- Legislative: Congress
- Judicial: Supreme Court
- Constitution
- Bill of Rights

Review

Read the information and trace the dotted words and branches.

Makes and enforces laws

Provides services and health care

Collects taxes to pay for services

Protects us and our property

Three Branches:
Executive
Legislative
Judicial

Government

Controls disagreements

Leaders:
Mayor
Governor
President

Four Levels:
City
County
State
National

Voters elect officials by casting ballots

Review

Read the information and trace the dotted words and branches.

This page intentionally left blank for creative use.

This page intentionally left blank for creative use.